SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #1 · FAMILY TRADITIONS AND HERITAGE

“We don't talk about our problems outside the family.”

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Where it often comes from

Many families, cultures, and churches prize privacy. Some of that is wise: not every struggle belongs on social media. But when the rule hardens into “never tell anyone,” abuse, addiction, depression, and money trouble can go unaddressed for years. Children learn to keep secrets, and adults carry hurts alone because speaking up feels like betrayal.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors both discretion and honesty. Paul writes, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” James says, “Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed.” Proverbs says, “He who conceals his sins will not prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them will find mercy.” And “Open your mouth for those with no voice.” Wisdom chooses whom to tell and how, but secrecy that keeps people suffering or in danger is not what God asks of a family.

> *“Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ”* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> “Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail” (James 5:16).

> “He who conceals his sins will not prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them will find mercy” (Proverbs 28:13).

> “Open your mouth for those with no voice, for the cause of all the dispossessed. Open your mouth, judge righteously, and defend the cause of the poor and needy” (Proverbs 31:8–9).

> “But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin” (1 John 1:7).

Common self-statements

- What happens at home stays at home.
- Talking about it would shame us.
- Strong families handle things privately.
- No one outside could understand.
- If I tell, I am betraying them.
- We just do not speak about that.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must tell everyone or no one.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never share family struggles.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that telling anyone will destroy the family.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling disloyal and concluding that I am.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn this rule, and what was it meant to protect?
- What has silence cost me and my family?
- Who is a wise, trustworthy person I could talk with?
- What is the difference between privacy and secrecy?
- Is anyone in danger because we are keeping quiet?
- What does Scripture say about bearing burdens together?

Truth summary

> Healthy privacy is wise, but silence that keeps people hurting is not. I can share my burdens with trustworthy people, seek help for my family, and still honor those I love. If anyone is in danger, speaking up is the loving thing to do.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Confession
- Communication
- Church
- Help
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "We don't talk about our problems outside the family"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"We don't talk about our problems outside the family." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is the rule in my family?
- ☐ What has silence cost?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ What is privacy and what is secrecy?
- ☐ Is anyone in danger?
- ☐ What will I share first?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ We are meant to carry burdens together.
- ☐ Confession and prayer lead to healing.
- ☐ Privacy and secrecy are not the same.
- ☐ Speaking up can be an act of love.
- ☐ I can choose wise, safe people.
- ☐ Light brings healing.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ James 5:16
  "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail."
- ☐ Proverbs 28:13
  "He who conceals his sins will not prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them will find mercy."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One honest conversation: Each week, note one honest conversation with a safe person and what you learned.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can carry burdens with others and still honor my family.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Confession" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the rule. Write the unspoken rule and who taught it.
- [ ] Pick a safe person. Choose a pastor, counselor, or trusted friend.
- [ ] Share one thing. Tell them part of the story and see how it goes.
- [ ] Get help if anyone is unsafe. If someone is in danger, call 911 or the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "We don't talk about our problems outside the family": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	An honest conversation
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~We don't talk about our problems outside the family.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my family taught me to keep quiet. Give me wisdom about whom to trust, courage to speak, and healing as I carry burdens with others. Protect those I love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.